

---BREAKDOWNS---

These are basically reels, but they reflect the dance culture of the central/southern US, where they're often called hoedowns. are popular contest pieces, usually elaborated in the "controlled improvisation" style pioneered by Eck Robertson, Benny Thomasson, Byron Berline, and others.

Done Gone

*Trad.
reel*

♩ = 110

A-part

B♭ Gm B♭ Gm

1 F 2 F B♭

B-part

B♭ Gm B♭ Gm B♭ Gm F

B♭ Gm B♭ Gm F F B♭

C-part

Gm D7

Gm D7 Gm

---HORNPIPES AND REELS---

Tunes organized alphabetically. Some ideas for sets:

- * Because He Was A Bonny Lad > Salmon Tails up the Water
- * Morpeth Rant > Old Morpeth Rant > Roxburgh Castle
- * King of Fairies > Off to California > Rights of Man
- * Silver Spear > Maid Behind the Bar
- * da New Rigged Ship > Shelder Geo > Sleep Soond

Written as sets:

"Shetland Reels": da Ferry Reel > Lay Dee at Dee > Miss Spencie's Reel

The Bamburgh Rants

The Collpitts, The General Gordon, and Ye Old Elm Tree

Martin Matthews
rant

$\text{♩} = 105$
Collpitt's



Gordon



Elm Tree





Notes: These are named after the 3 pubs which have hosted the Monday session in Durham over the last 50 years. Great recording at https://youtu.be/LkPSt-0y4q0?si=LX8cenzA4__PamoR.

The Big Scioto

(sigh-oh-tee)

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

B-part

A-part var.

B-part var.

Chords: G G G G | G C D G : | G D D Em | Em C D G : |

Notes: Named after the Scioto River in Ohio. Also spelled Sciota, Sciote.

Bitter Creek

Trad.
reel

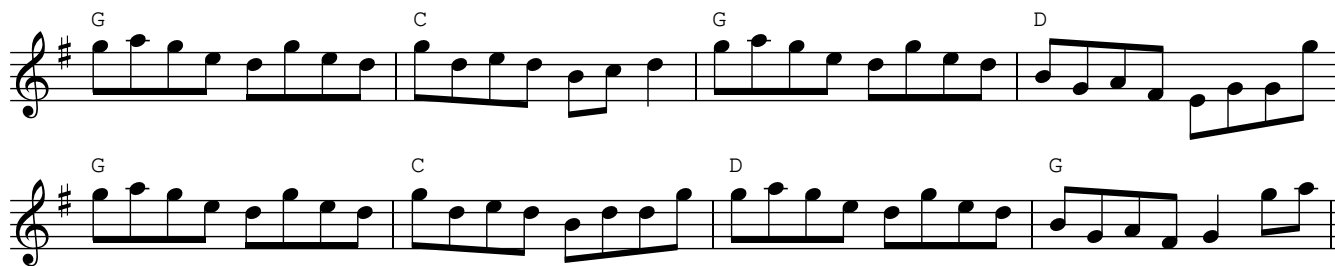
$\mathcal{J} = 105$

A-part

B-part

A-part (var.)

The image shows two staves of musical notation for the 'G C D G' exercise. The first staff contains four measures with chords G, C, G, and D. The second staff contains four measures with chords G, C, D, and G. The notation includes treble clefs, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and various note values and rests.



Chords: G C G D | G C D G :|

Source: A-part var. by Oscar Harper at https://tunearch.org/wiki/Bitter_Creek.

Blackberry Blossom

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

Chords: G/F#m C/G C/G A/D | G/F#m C/G C/G D/G :| Em/B7 Em/B7 Em B7 | Em/B7 Em/B7 Em/A D/G :|

Blackbird Hornpipe (1)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

Chords: D D G C | D D C D :| D G D A7 | D G C D :|

B-part

Chords: D D G C | D D C D :| D G D A7 | D G C D :|

B-part (low)

Chords: D D G C | D D C D :| D G D A7 | D G C D :|

Chords: D D G C | D D C D :| D G D A7 | D G C D :|

Source: Amanda Kerr; Randal Bays + Dave Marshall (with my own licks added)

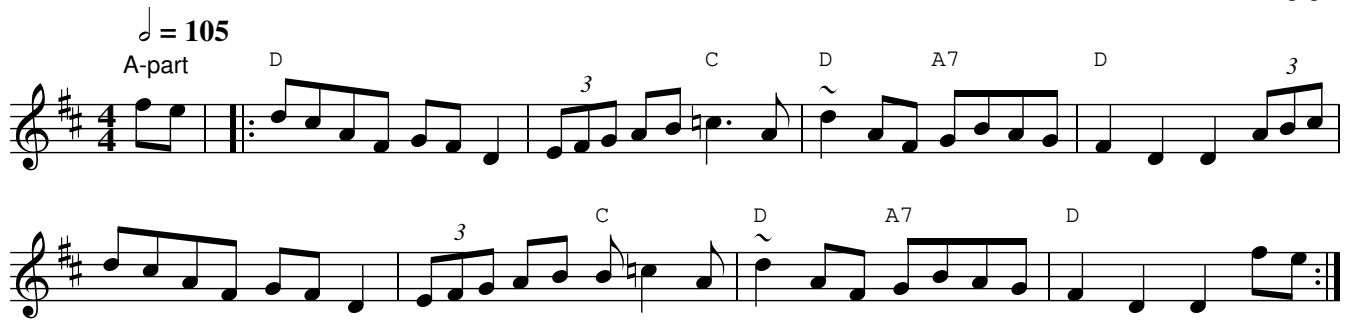
Notes: Another new tune for me. Seems to have a lot in common with The Blackbird set dance, with its repeated landing on the open D, but is also recognizably distinct. Still figuring out chords and fine-tuning the arrangement. One interesting feature is a "slippery" C, sometimes sharp in line with with the key signature and sometimes dropping down to natural.

Blackbird Hornpipe (2)

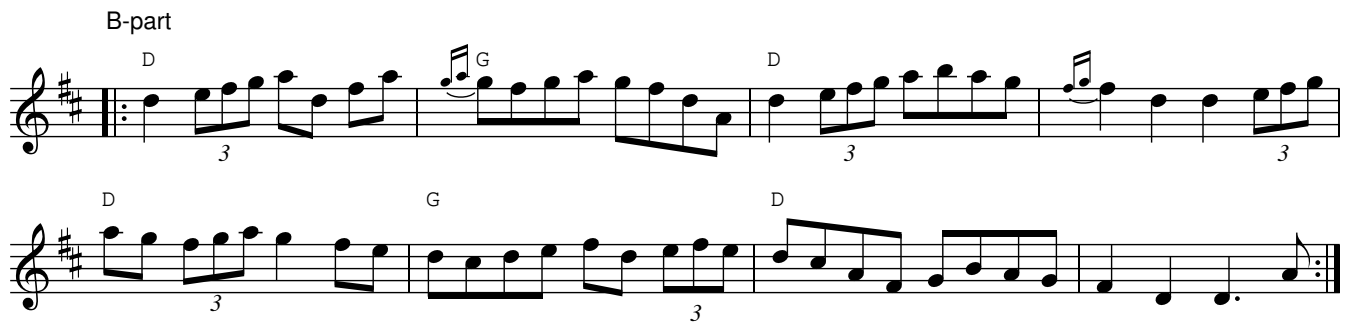
*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part



B-part



C-part



Source: Padraig McGovern and Peter Carberry: <https://youtu.be/5vidJn-Ebyc?si=eCc98qBibmGQ52gS>

Notes: This is another version of the Blackbird Hornpipe, clearly related to the previous one.

A little more repetitive, but in a good way! Good as a reference.

Chording remains basic / uncertain.

Boil The Breakfast Early

reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in 4/4 time, key of D major (one sharp). It consists of six staves of music. The first staff begins with a repeat sign and a tempo marking of 105 beats per minute. The melody is composed of eighth and sixteenth notes, with some triplets and slurs. The score ends with a double bar line and repeat dots.

Brenda Stubbert's Reel

a.k.a. Frosty Morning

*Jerry Holland
reel*

♩ = 105

A-part

Am Am G G

Am Am Em G Em Am

B-part

Am Am G G

Am Am Em G Em Am

A-part: Am Am/G G G | Am Am/Em G Em/A :|

B-part: Am Am G G | F F/C Em Em/A | <repeat A-part once>

Source: Ashley MacIssac, *Hi(tm) How Are You Today?* (1995)

Notes: Ashley plays it in Bb, but the standard key is A Dorian. I like his accidentals.

Butterfly Hornpipe

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

Chords: A A B7 E

Chords: A D E7 E A

B-part

Chords: E A B7 E

Chords: A B7 E E A

Chords: E A B7 E

Chords: A B7 E E A

A-part

Chords: A A B7 E

Chords: A D E7 E A

C-part

Chords: E A B7 E

Chords: A B7 E E A

Chords: A A B7 E | A D E7 E/A :| E A B7 E | A B7 E E/A :|

Source: Terry Morris, For the Record and other jam recordings.

Notes: For all his improvisational abilities, Terry is remarkably consistent with this tune.
I guess he liked it this way! :)

Cuckoo's Nest

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

B-part

Chords: D A7 C G | D D/G D/A7 D :| D D C C | D D/G D/A7 D :|

Notes: Interestingly, The Fiddler's Bible reverses the order of parts.

The Democratic Hornpipe

a.k.a. Galway Bay

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

B-part

Chords: Em Em G G | Em D B7 Em :| Em Em G D | G/D G/D B7 Em :|

Source: *The Fiddler's Bible* (transposed to Em)

Notes: A really interesting tune with a lot of movement. Also frequently played in Gm, but I don't want the guitarists to murder me. Chording is still tentative.

The Derry Reel

Eugene O'Donnell?
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

Chords: A E A D | A E A E/A :| F#m E F#m E/F#m | A E A E/A :|

B-part

Chords: A E A D | A E A E/A :| F#m E F#m E/F#m | A E A E/A :|

Chords: A E A D | A E A E/A :| F#m E F#m E/F#m | A E A E/A :|

Notes: Cobbled from two versions found at thesession.org/tunes/7671. I really like the B-part!

Fisher's Hornpipe (D)

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part

B-part

Chords: D/G D/G D/G D/A | D/G D/G A D : | A D A A | G D A D : |

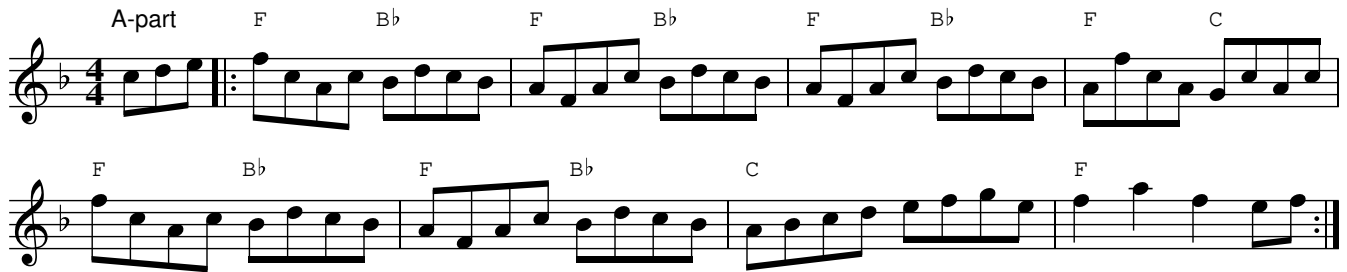
Notes: This is commonly played in either D or F major. Here are some examples of it in D, sourced and adapted from various transcriptions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/872>.

Fisher's Hornpipe (F)

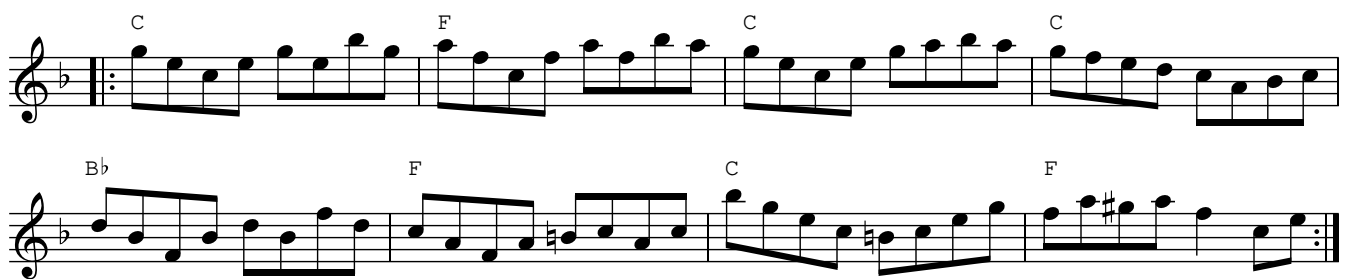
*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

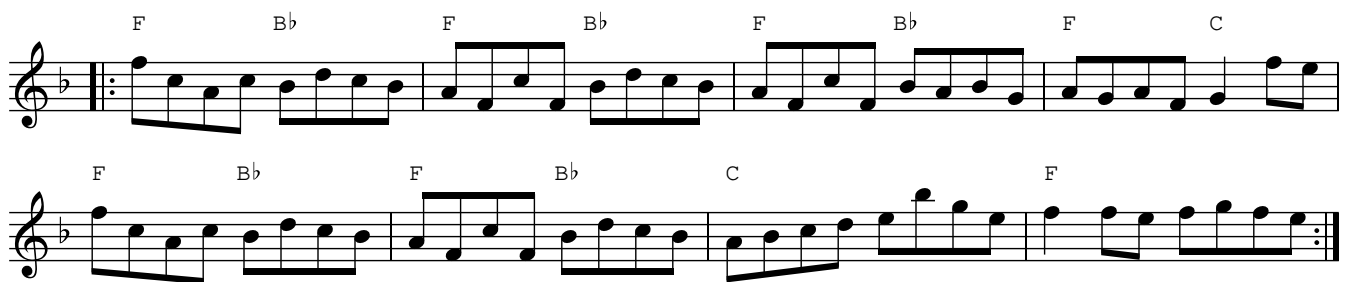
A-part



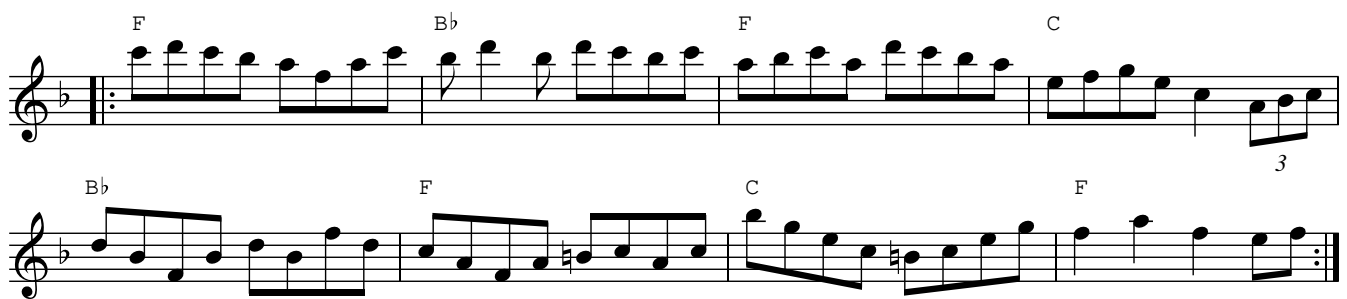
B-part



A-part (var.)



C-part



Chords: F/Bb F/Bb F/Bb F/C | F/Bb F/Bb C F :| C F C C | Bb F C F :| F Bb F C | Bb F C F :|

Notes: Here's the F version as I learned it, along with a nice variation on the A-part I found at <https://thesession.org/tunes/872>.

Gin Rickshaw

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

Chords: D Em D G D A7

B-part

Chords: D G D A7 D G A7 D

Chords: D Em D/G D/A | D Em D/G A/D :| D G D A7 | D G A7 D :|

Hummingbird Reel

Trad.
reel

$d = 105$

A-part

B-part

[illegible]

Chords: A/E A E E | A/E A E A :| A A E E | A A E A :|

The Humours of Tulla

*Trad.
reel*

♩ = 105

A-part

Two staves of music in D major (one sharp) and 4/4 time. The first staff contains four measures with chords D, D, Em, D, G, and A7. The second staff contains four measures with chords D, D, Em, D, G, and A7. A triplet of eighth notes is marked with a '3' in the second staff.

B-part

Two staves of music in D major (one sharp) and 4/4 time. The first staff contains four measures with chords D, D, G, D, G, and A7. The second staff contains four measures with chords D, D, G, D, G, and A7. Irish rolls are marked with tilde (~) signs in the first staff. A triplet of eighth notes is marked with a '3' in the second staff.

Chords: D D/Em D G/A7 :| D D/G D G/A7 :|

Source: Adapted from versions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/141>

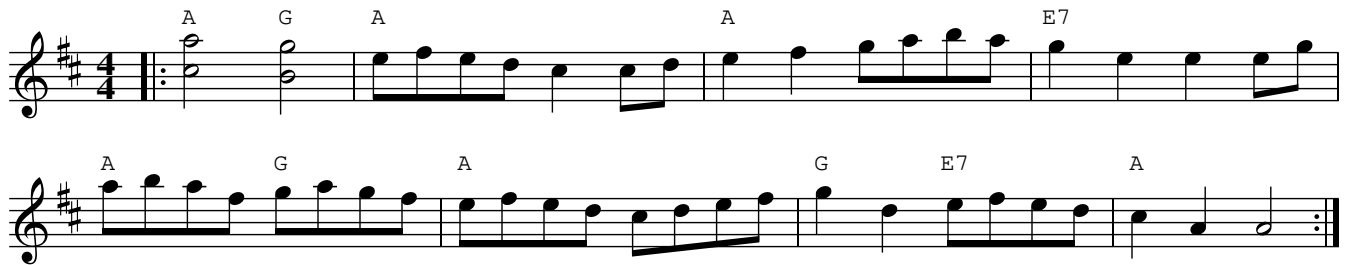
Notes: A fun tune I was shown in Durham! First comes the basic melody, then my variations.
The G and Em chords are fairly interchangeable. I mix and match them in this arrangement.
The ~ signs mark Irish rolls, meaning you need to do something like bow triplets to make it more interesting. Or fiddle through it, like I have in the second half of the B-part.

The Kitchen Girl

Trad.
reel

♩ = 105

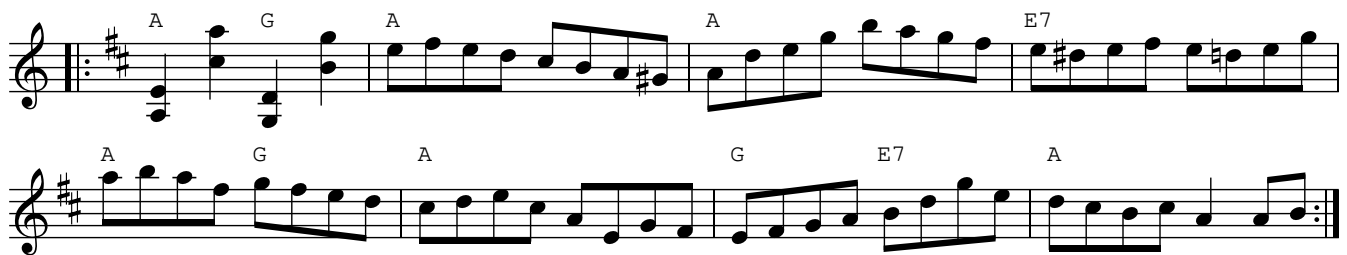
A-part



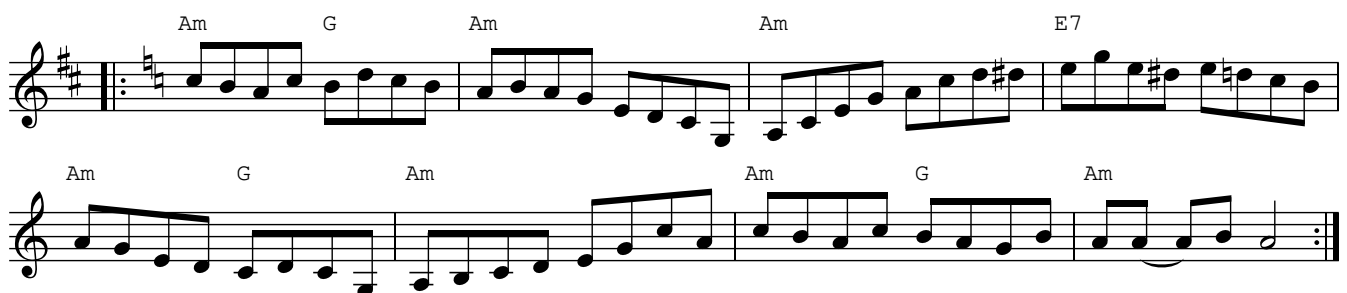
B-part



A-part (var.)



B-part (var.)



Chords: A/G A A E7 | A/G A G/E7 A :| Am/G Am Am E7 | Am/G Am Am G/Am

Source: _Kentucky Open Band Contra Tunes_, with some original variations.

Notes: Great jam tune. For inspiration, see https://youtu.be/912wUcMXG_0?feature=shared

Miller's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

A D E A E E

A D E A E E A

B-part

A B7 E B7

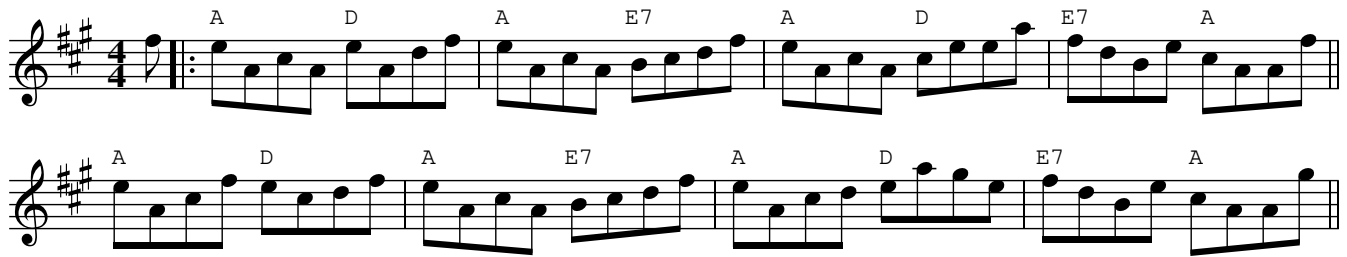
A D E E A

Chords: A/D E/A E E | A/D E/A E E/A :| A B7 E B7 | A D E E/A :|

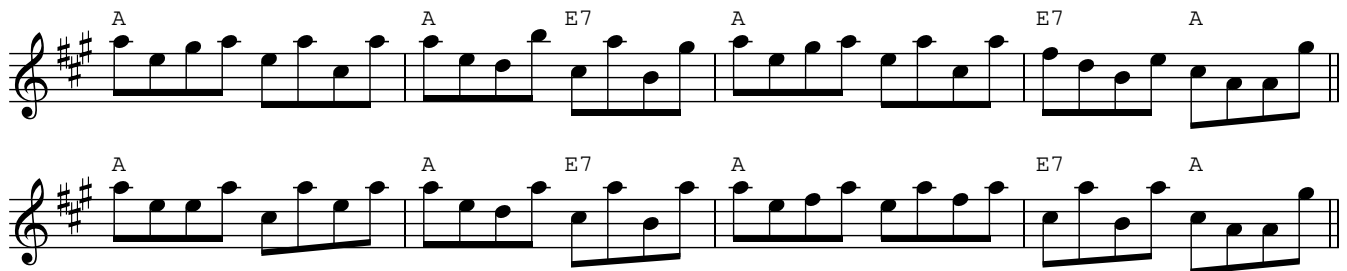
Money Musk

*Trad.
reel*

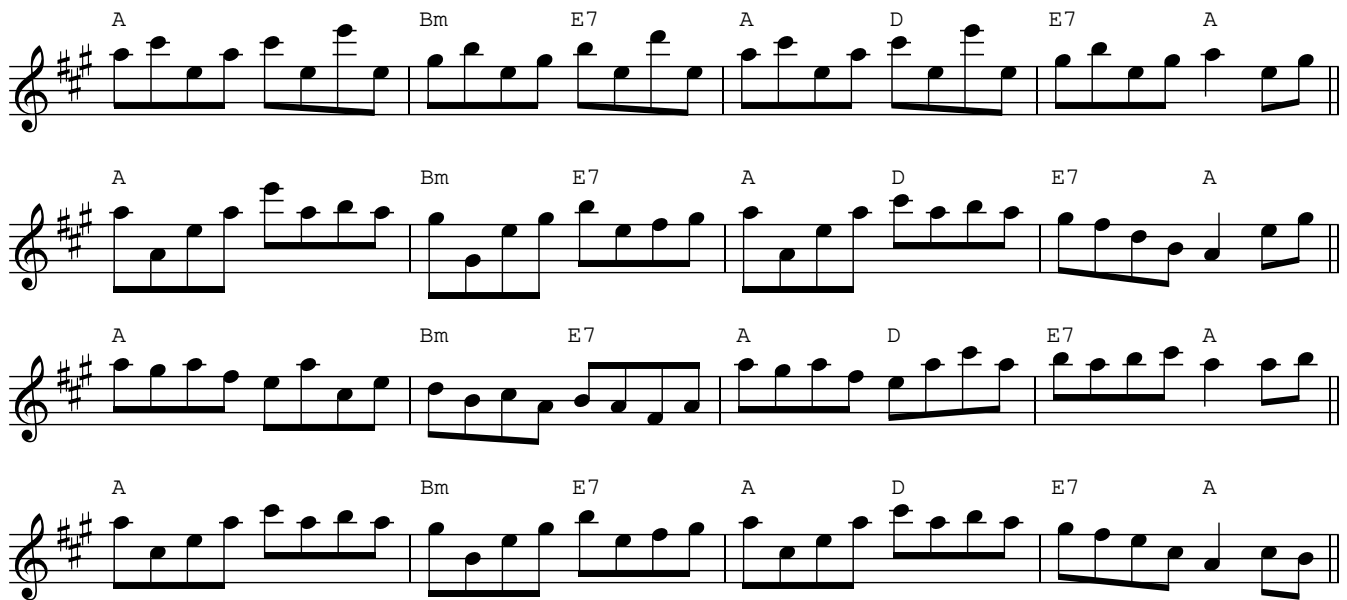
$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part (2 variations)



B-part (2 variations)



C-part (4 variations)



D-part



A-part: A/D A/E A/D E/A :| B-part: A A/E7 A E7/A :|

C-part: A Bm/E7 A/D E/A :| D-part: A/D A/E A/D E/A :|

Source: *_The Fiddler's Bible_* for the base, plus variations by Tom Wiesgerber.

Notes: Great tune with oodles of variations! Choose your favorite version(s) of A, B, and C, then play: Ax2 > Bx2 > Cx2 or D (some play both) > repeat from the top.

The Morpeth Rant

William Sheild
rant

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

B-part

Chords: D G/A D/G A7 | D G/A D/G A/D :| D G/Em A D | D G/Em A D :|

Source: Stewart Hardy, <https://youtu.be/ogZMXmpvqh4?si=OReaCGFonFyUaiGt>.

Notes: The unofficial "national" tune of Northumbria. It is popular to play this in a set with The Old Morpeth Rant and Roxburgh Castle.

The Old Morpeth Rant

*Trad.
rant*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

1 G C G D7 G

2 G C G D7 G

B-part

1 C D7 G D7 G

2 C D7 G D7 G

Chords: G C/G G/Am D7 | G C/G D7 D7/G :| G D7 C/Am D7 | C D7 G/D7 D7/G

It is also played in Bb! Here is the skeleton version:

Bb Eb Bb F7 Bb

Bb F7 Eb Cm F7

Eb F7 Bb F7 Bb

Source: Stewart Hardy, https://youtu.be/d0AWDc_zuK0?si=Nra7JSgGlfhzKS1A.

Notes: More regional interest: the rant is a local form, connected with the Rapper Sword dance; "musically it is similar to a reel, though somewhat slower, and with more of a lilt." (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Music_of_Northumbria)

The Mortgage Burn

Trad.
reel

$\mathcal{J} = 105$

The image displays a musical score for guitar, written in A major (indicated by three sharps: F#, C#, G#) and 4/4 time. The score consists of six staves of music, each with a key signature of three sharps and a 4/4 time signature. The music is written in a single melodic line, with various chords indicated above the notes. The chords are: A, Bm, E, D, and A. The score includes a variety of musical notation, including eighth notes, quarter notes, and half notes, as well as rests and accidentals. The first staff begins with a key signature change from C major to A major. The second staff features a key signature change from A major to E major (indicated by two sharps: F# and C#). The third staff returns to A major. The fourth staff begins with a key signature change from A major to E major. The fifth staff returns to A major. The sixth staff begins with a key signature change from A major to E major. The score is a single melodic line, with various chords indicated above the notes. The chords are: A, Bm, E, D, and A. The score includes a variety of musical notation, including eighth notes, quarter notes, and half notes, as well as rests and accidentals. The first staff begins with a key signature change from C major to A major. The second staff features a key signature change from A major to E major (indicated by two sharps: F# and C#). The third staff returns to A major. The fourth staff begins with a key signature change from A major to E major. The fifth staff returns to A major. The sixth staff begins with a key signature change from A major to E major.

A-part: A A Bm E7 | A A Bm E7/A :

B-part: A D/A Bm/A E/D | A D/A Bm/E E/A | A D/A Bm/A E/D | A A/D A/Bm E/A

Source: <https://thesession.org/tunes/2047>

New Reel

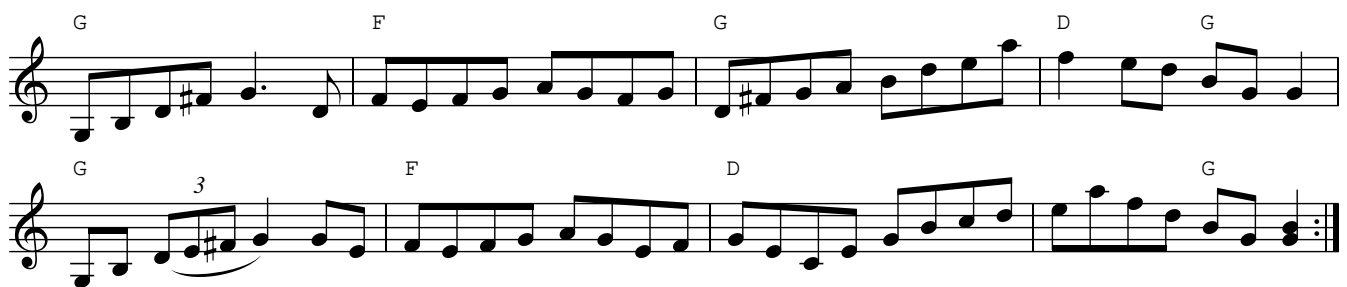
*Dale Morris
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part



B-part



A-part: G/F C/G C D/G :| G F G D/G | G F D D/G :|

Notes: A somewhat mysterious tune I found amongst the practice / lesson tapes from Dale Morris that my teacher passed on to me. I only have it down as "New Reel" (was it Dale's composition?), but it might be a traditional tune.

da New Rigged Ship + Shelder Geo

pronounced "gyo"

Trad.
reel

♩ = 105
da New Rigged Ship

Chords: A A G D : | A/E7 A/E7 A/E7 A : | Am/G Am/Em Am/G Am : |

Shelder Geo

Chords: D C/G D G/D : | C C C D : |

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990).

Notes: This set segues nicely to Sleep Soond i da Moarnin.

The Nine Points of Roguery

a.k.a. The Black Mare of Fanad

*Trad.
reel*

♩ = 105

A-part

Chords: D G D D Bm C Em

B-part

Chords: C G D D C Em

A-part (var.)

Chords: D G D D Bm C Em

B-part (var.)

Chords: C G D D C Em

Chords: D/G D D/Bm C/Em | D/G D D A7/D :| C/G D D/Bm C/Em | C/G D D A7/D :|

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990) plus bits of thesession.org/tunes/429 and my own additions.

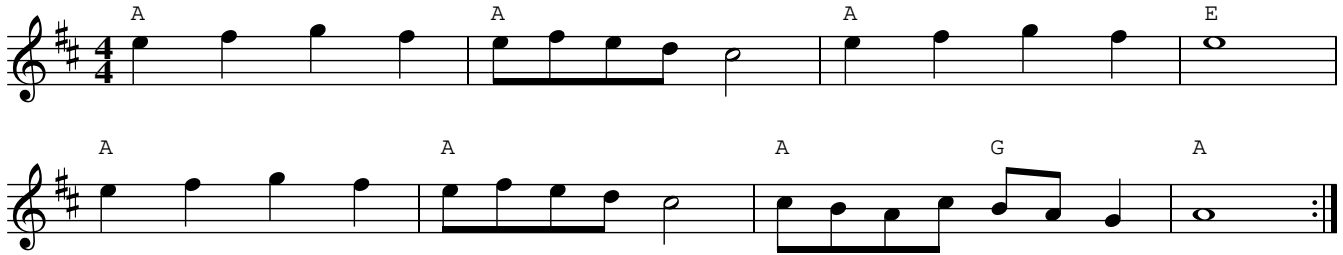
Notes: It seems many versions of this tune place an Em chord in the fourth bar of both parts. Maggie goes to a C instead, and I like that.

Old Joe Clark

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part



B-part



A-part == | B-part ==

A A A · E | A A A · G

A A A/G A | A A A/G A

Notes: This is a popular bluegrass tune. Here is a simple version I got from a mandolin lesson.
Will work with this more in the future.

Old Straw Bonnet

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

B-part

C-part

A-part === | B-part == | C-part ====

G F G D7 . | G G F F . | Gm Gm Gm D7

G F G D7/G | G C D D/G | Gm Gm D7 D7/Gm

Notes: Great tune; this is the basic way I play it.

Opera Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part (1)

Two staves of music for the first part of the A-section. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a treble clef. Chords are indicated above the notes: D, D, A, D, G, A. The first staff ends with a repeat sign. The second staff continues the melody and ends with a double bar line.

A-part (2)

Two staves of music for the second part of the A-section. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a treble clef. Chords are indicated above the notes: D, D, A, D, G, A. The first staff ends with a triplet of eighth notes. The second staff continues the melody and ends with a double bar line.

B-part (1)

Two staves of music for the first part of the B-section. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a treble clef. Chords are indicated above the notes: D, A, D, G, D, G, A, D. The first staff ends with a double bar line. The second staff continues the melody and ends with a double bar line.

B-part (2)

Two staves of music for the second part of the B-section. The key signature is one sharp (F#) and the time signature is 4/4. The melody is written on a treble clef. Chords are indicated above the notes: D, A, D, G, D, G, A, D. The first staff ends with a double bar line. The second staff continues the melody and ends with a triplet of eighth notes and a double bar line.

A-part ==== | B-part =====

D D/A D G/A | D/A D/G D/G A/D

D D/A D G/A | D/A D/G D/G A/D

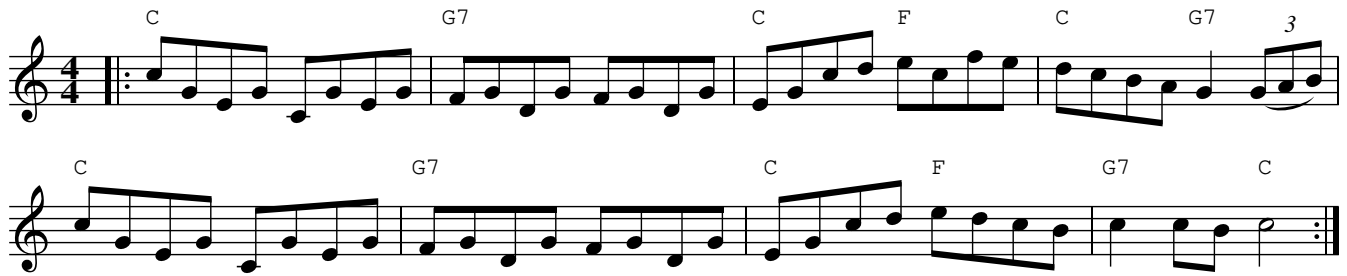
Source: _KY Contra Tunes_ and some online variants

Notes: This is interesting! Basically the usual A and B parts, but each part seems to have distinct variations on each. Also neat that the A part resolves on the dominant instead of the tonic.

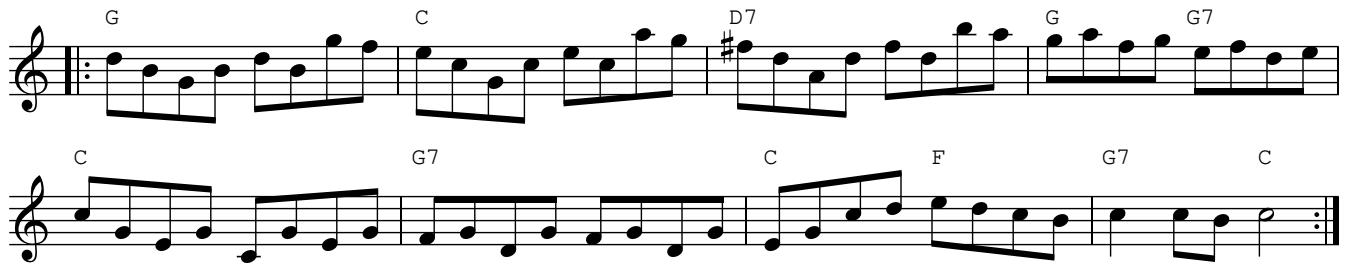
Peerless Hornpipe

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part



B-part



Chords: G C/G G/Am D7 | G C/G D7 D7/G :| G D7 C/Am D7 | C D7 G/D7 D7/G :|

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_.

Queen of the West

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part

D A D G

D A D A

D G 1 A D 2 A D

B-part

A D G E

E A A D

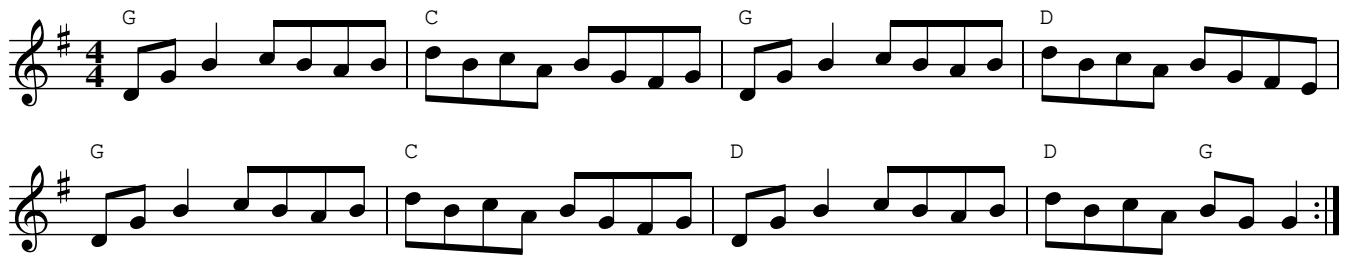
G A 1 D 2 D

Chords: D A D/G D/A | D A D/G A/D :| A D G/E E/A | A D G/A D :|

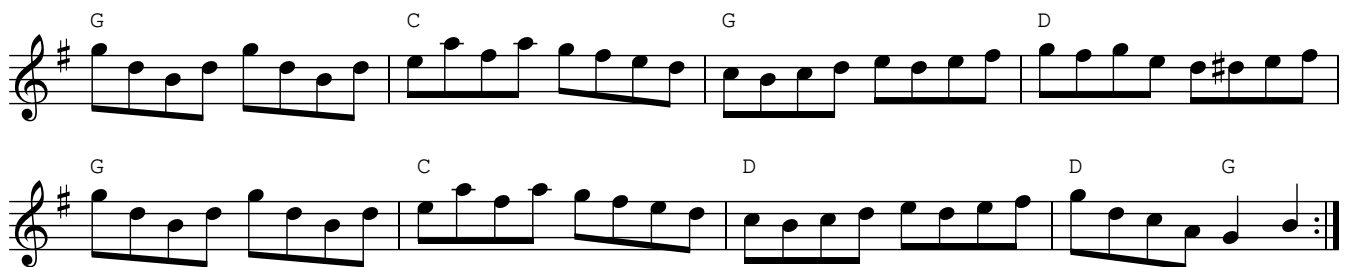
Rackety Jack's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part



B-part



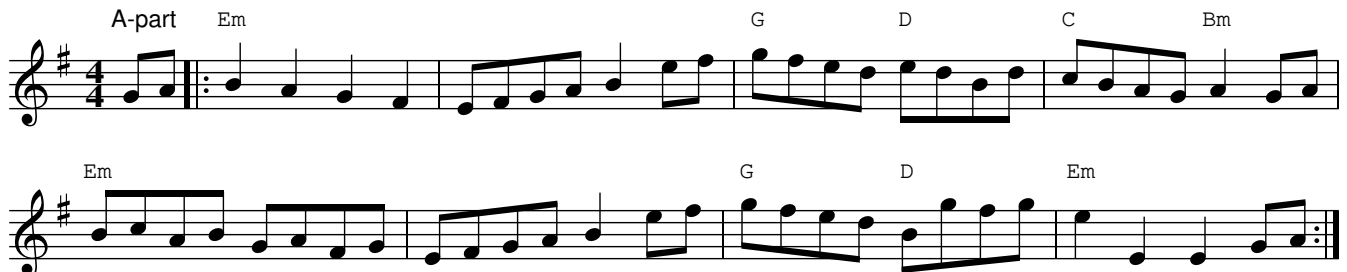
Chords: G C G D | G C D/G :|

Source: _The Fiddler's Bible_.

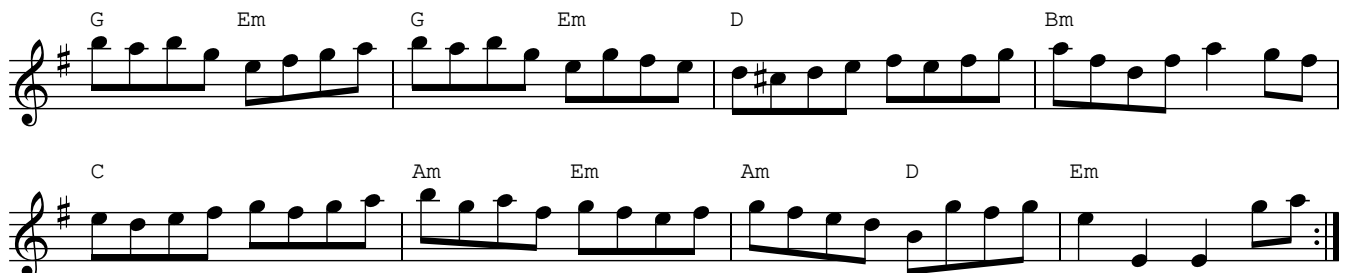
The Rights of Man

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part



B-part



Chords: Em Em G/D C/Bm | Em Em G/D Em :| G/Em G/Em D Bm | C Am/Em Am/D Em :|

Notes: Popularly paired with The Democratic Hornpipe.

Also features in the set: King of Fairies > Off to California > Rights of Man.

Roxburgh Castle

*Trad.
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

B-part

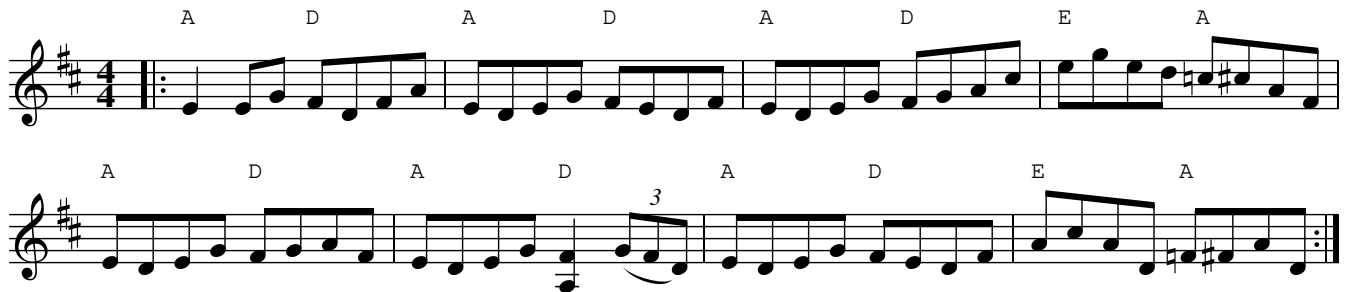
Chords: G C/G C Am/D7 | G C G/D7 G :| G G C/G Am/D7 | G C G/D7 G :|

Source: <https://thesession.org/tunes/4628>

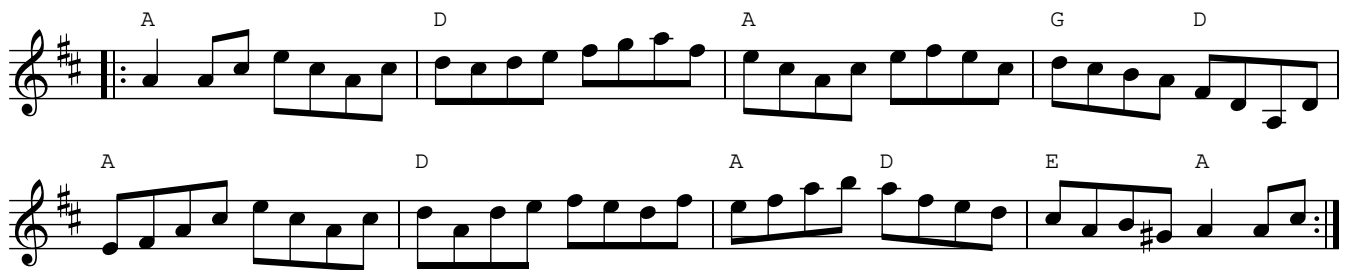
Rye Straw (D)

Trad.
reel

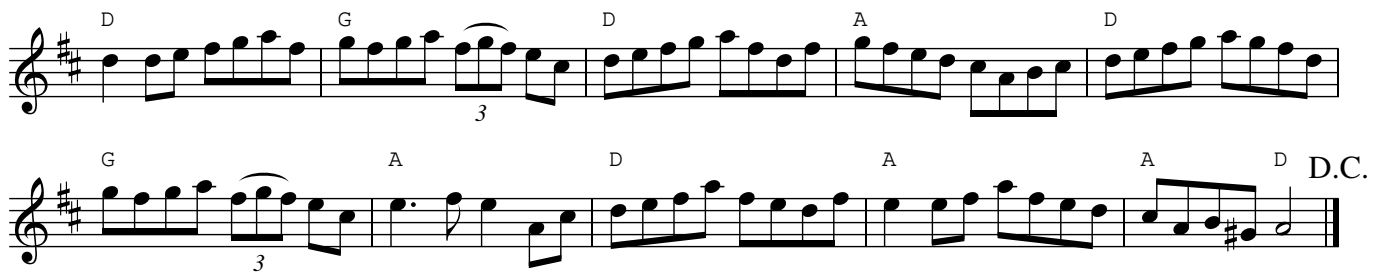
$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part



B-part



C-part



A-part ===== | B-part ===== | C-part =====
A/D A/D A/D E/A | A D A · G/D | D G D A
A/D A/D A/D E/A | A D A/D E/A | D G A D [A A/D]

Source: Todd Phillips + Darol Anger, In the Pines (1995) [with many modifications]

Notes: Rye Straw seems to have a zillion variations. The core of this version draws from Darol Anger's arrangement, where he seems to mash the 16 bars of one of its usual B-parts to create a 'bridge' C-part of 10 bars. It's pretty neat!

Rye Straw (D) v.2

*Trad. + Dave Notman
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part

A

D

A

1 D

2 D

B-part

A

D

A

D

A

D

G

D

A

D

A

D

1 G A

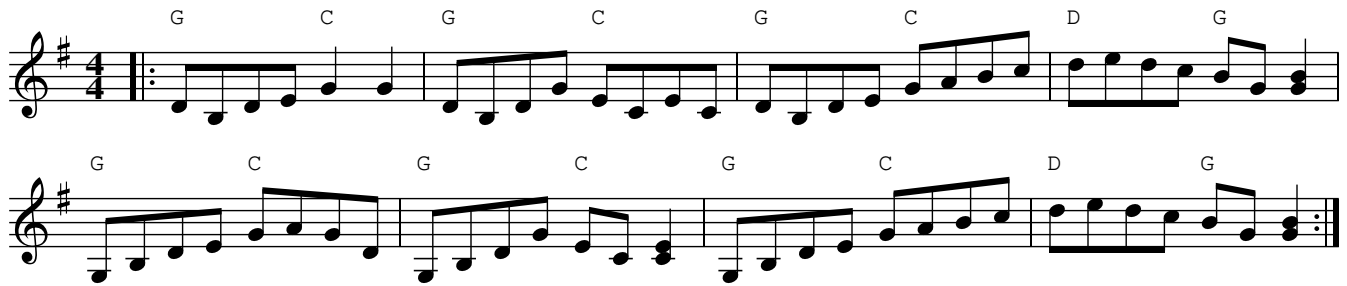
2 G A

Notes: A version of Rye Straw heavily modified by Dave Notman.

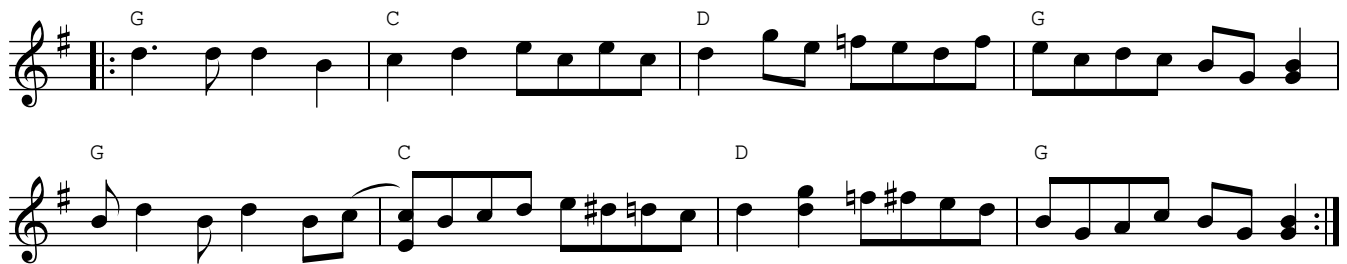
Rye Straw (G)

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part



B-part



Chords: G/C G/C G/C D/G :| G C D G :|

Source: Doc Roberts, followed by a few variations I've heard.

Notes: Note about the chords - this can easily follow a straight G pattern, but I kind of like the "rocking" pattern between G and C on the A part that I've heard in other versions.

Saint Anne's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

B-part

A-part ==== | B-part=

D/A D G · D | D G A D

D/A D G/A D | D G A D

Source: A combination of two versions at thesession.org/tunes/103

Notes: A rather jaunty tune, with a nice melody. Something to explore?

Sally Growler

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

Chords: G C G C G A D

B-part

Chords: G G D7 D7 G

Chords: G C/G C/G A/D | G C/G C/G D/G :| G G D7 D7 | G G D7 G :|

Salt Creek

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part A

A-part

G E A A D

1 2

A E A A E A

B-part

A A G G A A E A

Chords: A A/D G G/E | A A/D A E/A :| A A G G | A A A E/A :|

Source: An online intro to mandolin tutorial

Notes: VERY similar to Salt River, but the B-part is different

Salt River

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 100$

A-part

First A-part of the Salt River reel, consisting of four staves of music in 4/4 time. The key signature is two sharps (F# and C#). The melody is written in treble clef. Chords are indicated by letters A, G, D, and E above the notes. The first staff has chords A, A, G, G. The second staff has chords A, D, E, E, A. The third staff has chords A, A, G, G. The fourth staff has chords A, D, E, E, A.

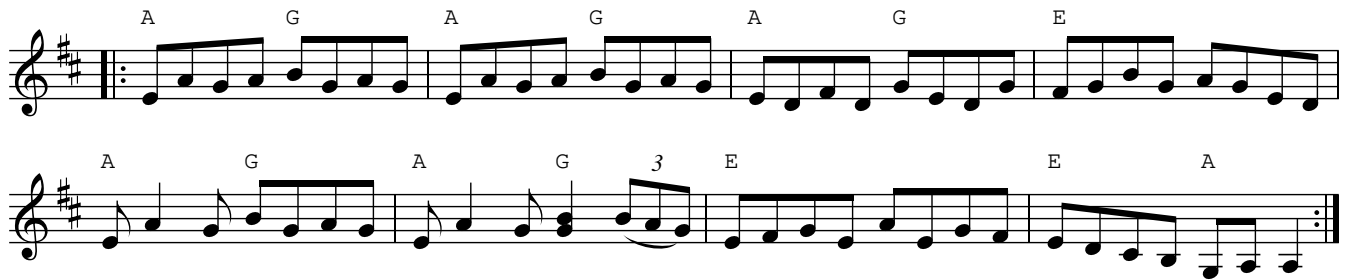
B-part

B-part of the Salt River reel, consisting of two staves of music in 4/4 time. The key signature is two sharps (F# and C#). The melody is written in treble clef. Chords are indicated by letters A, G, and E above the notes. The first staff has chords A, G, A, G, A, G, E. The second staff has chords A, G, A, G, E, E, A.

A-part

Second A-part of the Salt River reel, consisting of four staves of music in 4/4 time. The key signature is two sharps (F# and C#). The melody is written in treble clef. Chords are indicated by letters A, G, D, and E above the notes. The first staff has chords A, A, G, G. The second staff has chords A, D, E, E, A. The third staff has chords A, A, G, G. The fourth staff has chords A, D, E, E, A.

B-part (low, play in 3rd position)



A-part: A A G G | A D E E/A

B-part: A/G A/G A/G E | A/G A/G E E/A

Notes: So this is clearly the same base tune as Salt Creek, but it has drifted in different directions, depending on who is playing it. This version is based on Terry and Dale Morris's.

Saratoga Hornpipe

Trad.
hornpipe

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

Chords: F, B $\flat$, F, B $\flat$, F, G, C, F, B $\flat$, F, G, C, F

B-part

Chords: Dm, Dm, A7, A7, Dm, Dm, A7, Dm, Dm, A7, A7, Dm, C

A-part

Chords: F, B $\flat$, F, B $\flat$, F, G, C, F, B $\flat$, F, G, C



B-part

A-part ===== | B-part =====
 F/Bb F B/F G/C | Dm Dm A7 A7 (3x)
 F/Bb F G/C F · | Dm Dm A7 Dm/C

Source: Assembled from versions by Chris Daring, Terry Morris, Christine King, and Tom Weisgerber.
 Notes: Great tune. So many great ways to play it.

Shetland Set

da Ferry Reel, Lay Dee at Dee, and Miss Spencie's Reel

Trad.
reel

$\text{♩} = 105$
Ferry Reel

Chords: D, Bm, G, Em, A, D, Bm, G, A, A, B $\flat$ 0, Bm, G, A, D

Lay Dee at Dee

Chords: D, D, D, A, D, D, A, A, Bm, G, A, D

Miss Spencie's Reel

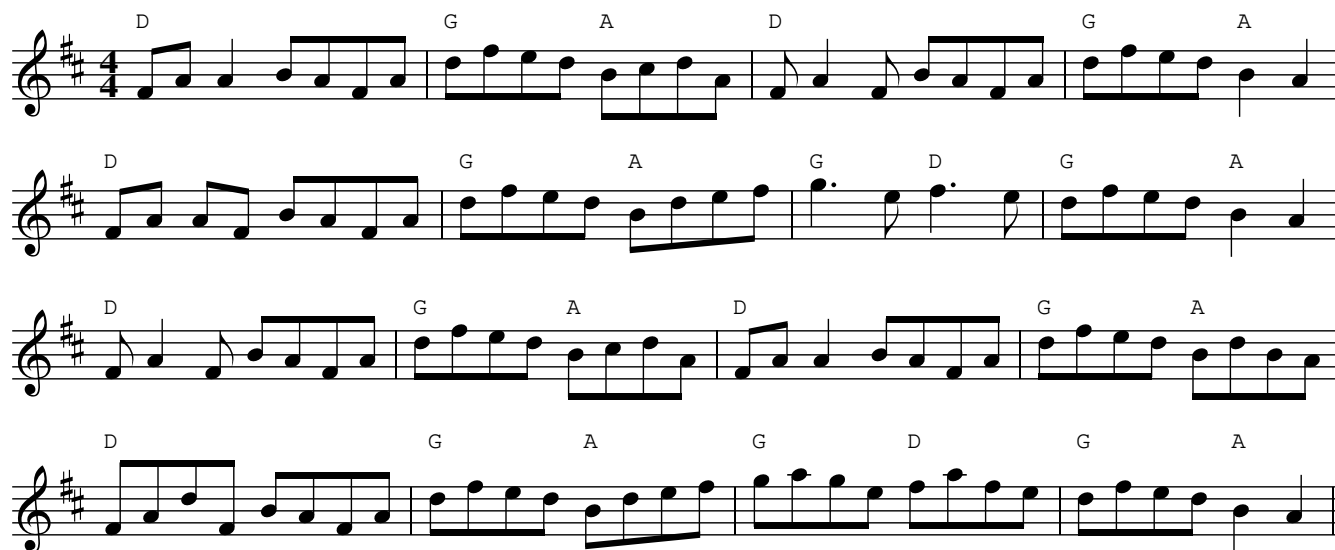
Chords: D, C, G, D, D, A, D, A, D

Notes: Some Shetland reels. I was originally going to list these separately, but they seem often to be grouped in a set.

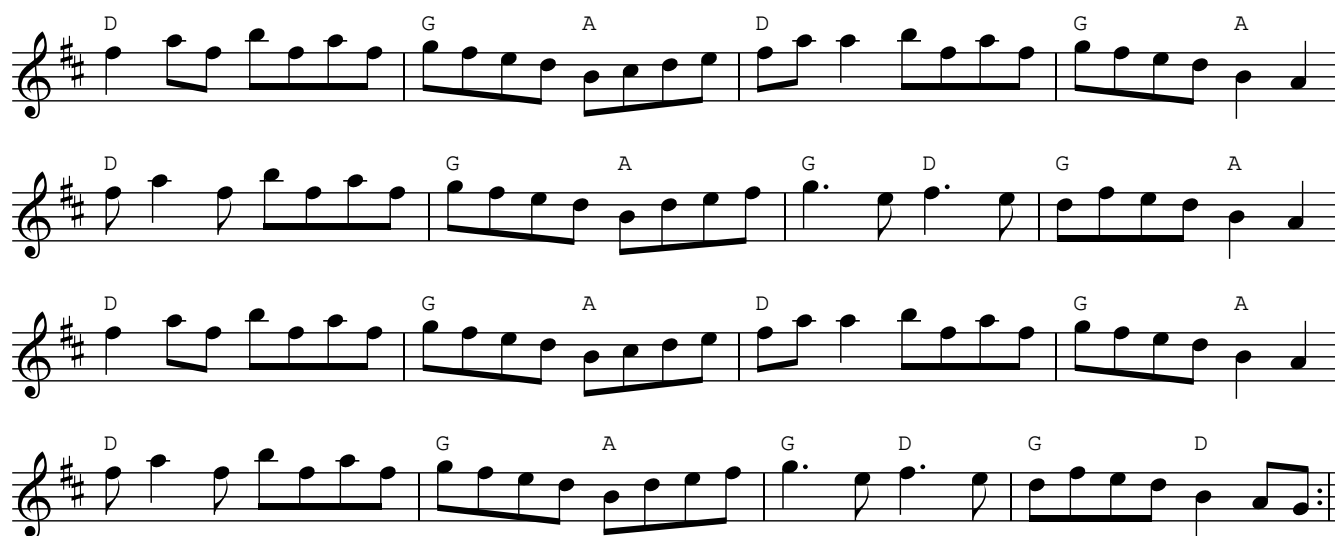
The Silver Spear

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$
A-part



B-part



A-/B-parts ==

D G/A D · G/A

D G/A G/D G/A

Source: Adapted from versions at <https://thesession.org/tunes/182>

Notes: A fun tune I was shown in Durham! Popularly paired with Maid Behind the Bar.

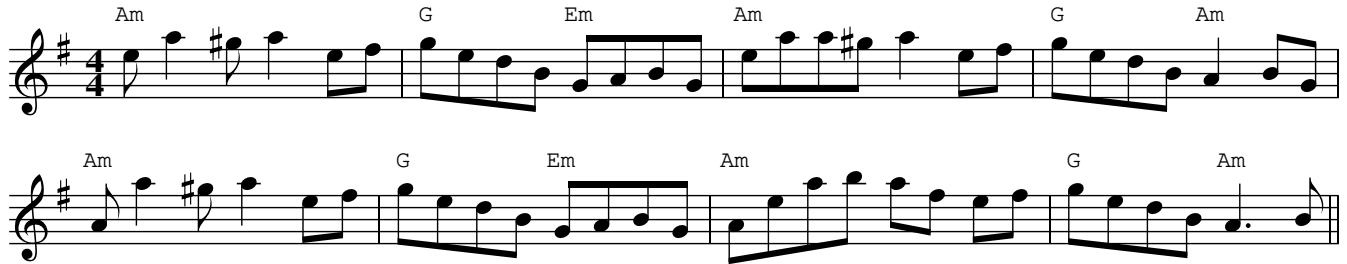
Sleep Soond i da Moarnin'

Sleep Sound in the Morning

Trad.
reel

♩ = 105

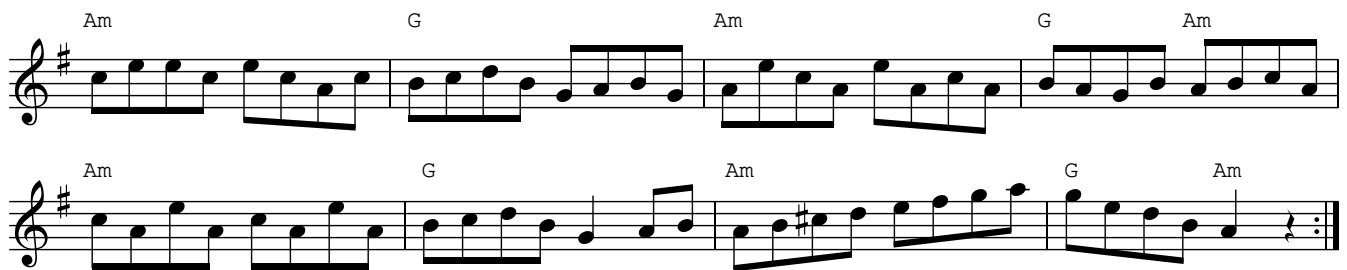
A-part



B-part



B-part (var.)



A-part ===== | B-part =====

Am G/Em Am G/Am | Am G Am G/Am

Am G/Em Am G/Am | Am G Am G/Am

Source: Maggie Sansone, *_Mist and Stone_* (1990).

Notes: Note on the B-part variant: I don't know why, but I always want to play the last C of the rising run as a C#. I know it's out of the key, but I think it sounds awesome.

Smith's Reel

*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

Chords: D G D A | D G A/AD : | Bm G D A | Bm G A A/D

B-part

Chords: Bm G D A | Bm G A A/D

A-part (var.)

Chords: D G D A | D G A/AD : | Bm G D A | Bm G A A/D

Chords: D G D A | D G A/AD : |

Bm G D A | Bm G A A/D

Alt.: D G D/Bm E7/A7 | D G D/Bm A7/D : | D/Bm G D/Bm E7/A7 | D/Bm G D/Bm A7/D : |

Source: Cameron Cross and Joey McKensie

Notes: I've seen some versions where the first chord in the A-part is Bm. I want to like it, but it sounds a little off.

The Spinning Dogs (of Carrowkennedy)

*Damian Caisley
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

1 Bm Em A Bm

2 Bm Em A A7

B-part

D A A7 Bm

Chords: Bm Em A A | Bm Em A Bm :| D D A A7 | D D A Bm :|

Notes: I've made very minute changes to the original music as it was given me to better accommodate my playing style.

The Stage Hornpipe

*James Hill
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

Chords: G G Am D7 | G C D7 D7/G : | G Am/G G/Am Am/D7 | G Am/G G/Am D7/G : |

Chords: G G Am D7 | G C D7 D7/G : | G Am/G G/Am Am/D7 | G Am/G G/Am D7/G : |

Source: Adapted from <https://thesession.org/tunes/1249>

The Twenty-Eighth of January

Trad.
reel

♩ = 105

A-part

Am D Am D Am G F Em

Am D Am D Am Em Am

B-part

Am Am G G Em

Am Am G Em Am

A-part (var.)

Am D Am D Am G F Em

Am D Am D Am Em Am

B-part (var.)

Am Am G G Em Am

Am Am G Em Am

A-part: A/D A/D Am/G F/Em | A/D A/D Am Em/Am

B-part: Am Am G G/Em | Am Am G Em/Am

Source: _KY Contra Tunes_ and thesession.org/tunes/15717 for the base

Notes: Now this is an interesting number! The A-part uses the "Dorian vamp," pretty unusual in fiddle tunes but a staple in classic rock. Seems like a popular bluegrass tune.

Westmoreland's Hornpipe

*Terry Morris
hornpipe*

$\text{♩} = 105$

A-part

D Em D A

B-part

D G D A

A-part (var.)

D Em D A

Chords: D Em D A | D Em A A/D :| D G D A | D Em A D :|

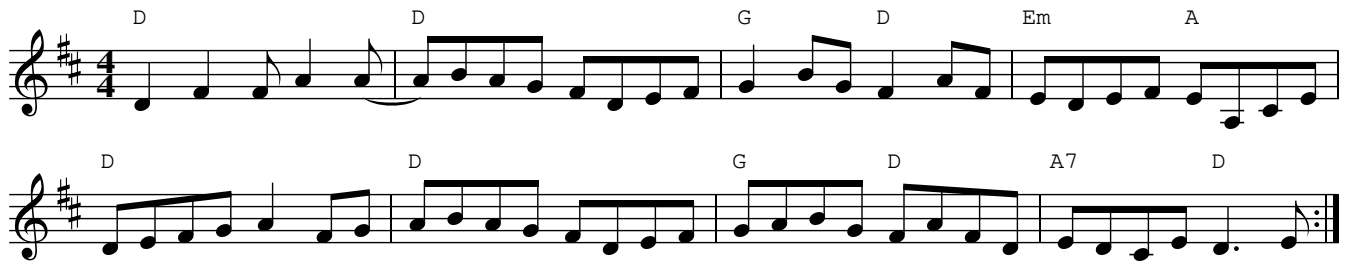
Source: Terry Morris, *_Touch of Texas_* (1976)

Whiskey Before Breakfast

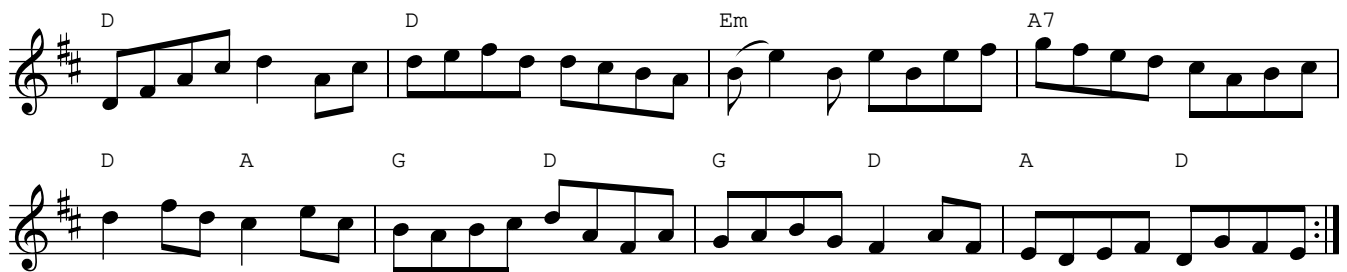
*Trad.
reel*

$\text{♩} = 105$

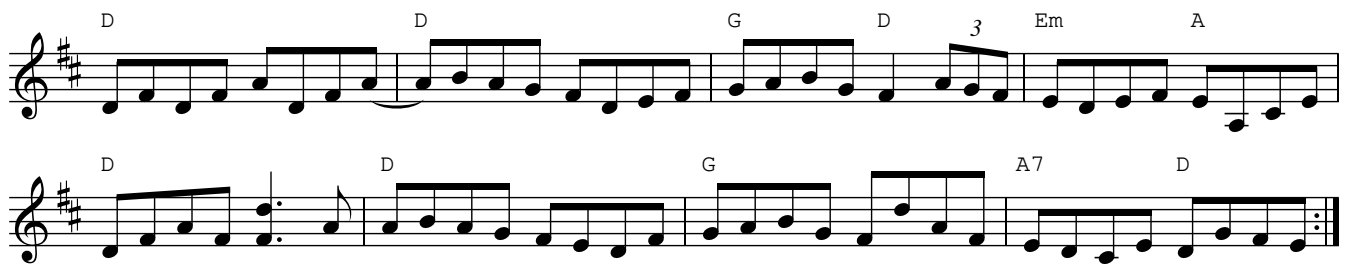
A-part



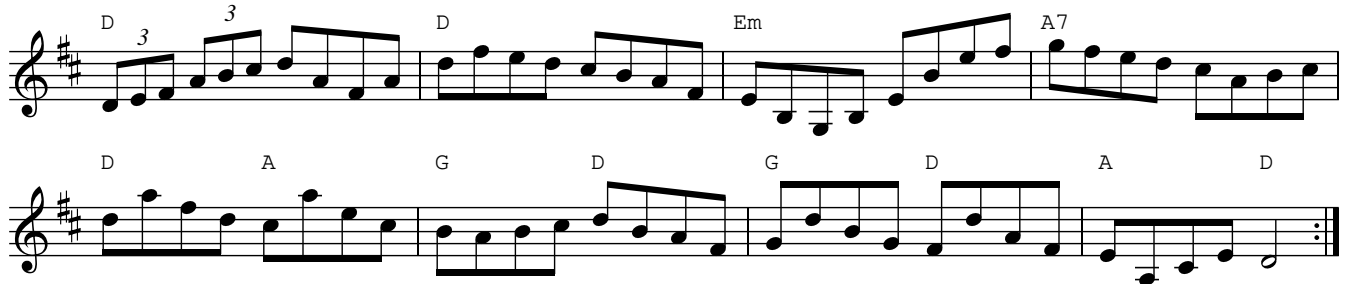
B-part



A-part



B-part



Chords: D D G/D Em/A | D D G/D A7/D :| D D Em A7 | D/A G/D G/D A/D :|

Source: Cam Cross

Notes: Classic, beautiful tune. Rough transcription of how I like to play it.

---JIGS AND SLIPJIGS---

Tunes organized alphabetically.

The Ballykeal Jig

jig

$\text{♩} = 100$

F F G G

F F D 1 G 2 G

G D G D

G D D 1 G 2 G

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)

Notes: Chords very tentative (again).

Brose and Butter + Cuzle Together

BB a.k.a. The Peacock Followed The Hen

*Trad.
slipjig*

$\text{♩} = 100$

Am G Am G C G C D G

Bonnie's variation

A G A G A D G

Cuzle Together

A G A D G

Edor version by Fraser and Haas

Em D Em D G A G D Em D

Source: Bonnie Rideout, *_Scottish Fire_* (2000); A. Fraser and N. Haas, *_Fire & Grace_* (2004).

Notes: Bonnie plays this on the viola and it sounds awesome. I've transposed it up a fifth to work on the fiddle. Another interesting thing is that she switches between A dorian (with a C natural) - which seems to be the standard - and mixolydian (C sharp). She combines B&B with Cuzle Together, another slipjig also in Amix (as well as Elsie Marly). This is supplemented with a version in Edor by Fraser and Haas, with a nice B-part.

The Butterfly

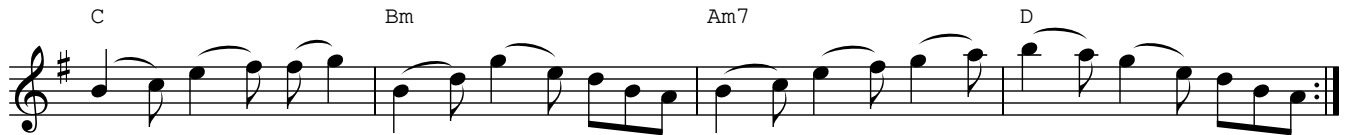
Tommy Potts
slipjig

$\text{♩} = 100$

A-part



B-part



C-part



A-part: Em/D Em/Bm Em/D C/D :|

B-part: C .. Bm .. Am . D . :|

C-part: G .. G/D . G .. C/D :| (The Gs can be substituted for Ems if preferred)

Source: The Good Tune

Notes: I've modified the bowing to something that makes more sense to me. But of course this is just a model to be played with.

The Maid At The Spinning Wheel

jig

$\text{♩} = 100$

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in G major (one sharp) and 6/8 time. The tempo is marked as a jig with a quarter note equal to 100 beats per minute. The score consists of six staves of music. The first staff begins with a treble clef, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and a 6/8 time signature. The melody is composed of eighth and sixteenth notes, with some beamed sixteenth notes. Chord symbols (G, D, A) are placed above the staff to indicate the harmonic structure. The second staff includes first and second endings, marked '1 G' and '2 G'. The third and fourth staves continue the melody, with the fourth staff also featuring first and second endings. The fifth and sixth staves conclude the piece, with the sixth staff including first and second endings. The notation includes various musical symbols such as stems, beams, and accidentals (sharps and naturals).

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)

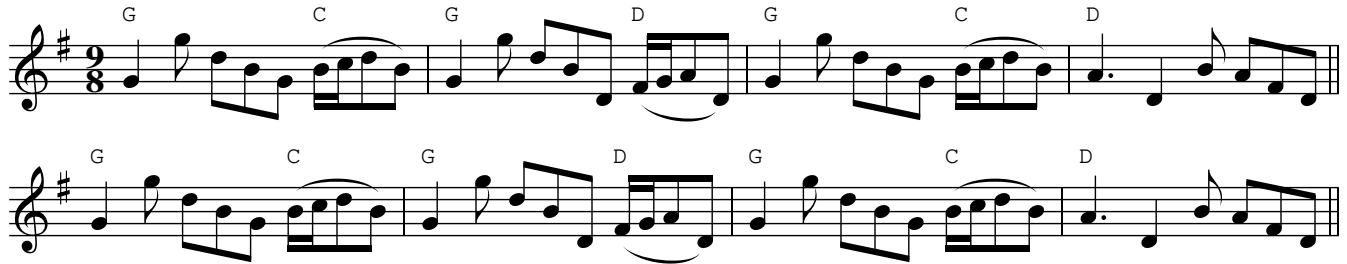
The Yorkshire Trip

a.k.a. Danish Slipjig

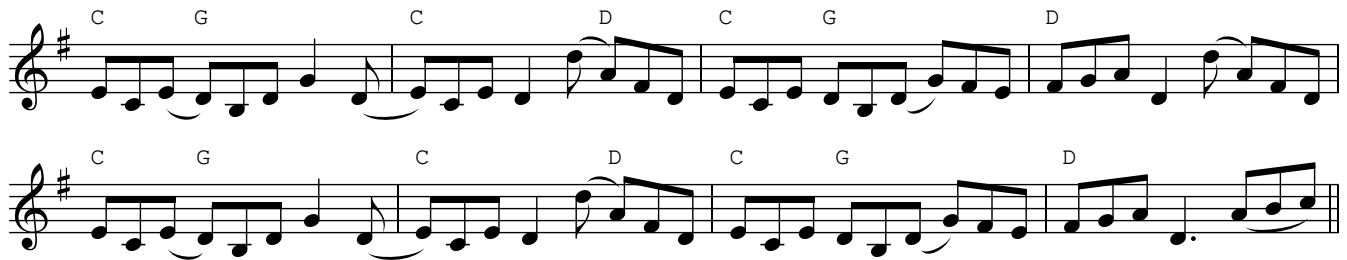
*Trad.
slipjig*

$\text{♩} = 100$

A-part



B-part



C-part



A-part: G/G/C G/G/D G/G/C D :|

B-part: C/G/G C/D/D C/G/G D :|

C-part: Em .. D ... C ... D :|

Source: William Vickers' Collection of Dance Tunes (1770); The Good Tune

Notes: A very nice slipjig; the sixteenth notes in the first part give it a distinctive touch.

---TUNES OF CHOICE---

Includes polkas, set dances, swing tunes...

The Blackbird (Set Dance)

*Trad.
set dance*

$\text{♩} = 80$

A-part

B-part

Source: Bobby Gardiner (Memories of Claire, 1996), with my own variations.

Notes: Lovely tune! Unusually (as far as I know), each part ends with an extra two beats.

Has a strong melodic sympathy with the Blackbird Hornpipe. D mixolydian, chords tentative.

Codladh na madraí fada

(Sleep of the Long Dogs)

James Jackson, 2026
air

$\text{♩} = 115$

Em D G D C G Am Bm

Em D G D C G Bm Em

Em D C D G D Am D

Em D C D C G Bm Em

A-part: Em D G D | C G Am Bm || Em D G D | C G Bm Em :|

B-part: Em D C D | G D Am D || Em D G D | C G Bm Em :|

Source: James Jackson

Notes: Written as a lament over the site of a mass grave of greyhounds; see
<http://news.bbc.co.uk/1/hi/england/wear/6457185.stm>. Play slowly with feeling and ornamentation.

Jezebel Carol

*Trad.
carol*

$\text{♩} = 160$

B min

Bm

A

Bm

D

A

Bm

A

Bm

F#m

A

Bm

A min

Am

G

Am

C

G

Am

G

Am

Em

Am

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990); Áine Minogue (Between the Worlds, 1997).

Notes: This interesting tune has an extra beat at the end. I've also found it played in both A and B minor. Chords remain tentative.

The Old Crossroads

a.k.a. Down The Brae

*Trad.
march*

♩ = 130

Em G Em D D Bm

Em Em G Em D Bm Em

Em Em G D D Bm

Em Em G Em D Bm Em

Source: Maggie Sansone (Mist and Stone, 1990)

---WALTZES---

Ameila('s Waltz)

Trad.
waltz

♩ = 160

A-part

Chords: D, D, Bm, F#m, G, D, Bm, G, D, D, Bm, F#m, G, G, A, 1, 3, 2

B-part

Chords: D, D, A, A, Bm, Bm, F#m, F#m, G, D, A, D, G, D, A, D

Source: Natalie MacMaster (A Compilation, 1996)

Notes: Play it heavily swung.

(The) April (Waltz)

*Trad.
waltz*

$\text{♩} = 180$

Chords: G, D, C, D, Bm, Em, C, G, D7, G, Dsus, Em, C, G, Em, C, D, Em, Em, C, D, Em, C, G, D, C.

Captain O'Kane

*Trad.
waltz*

♩ = 180

A-part

Em Em D Bm C Am Em Em Em D Bm C Am Em Em

B-part

Em Em D Bm Am G Bm Em G Em7 D Bm 3 G Am Em Em

Source: Loosely adapted from Maggie Sansone (Mist & Stone, 1990)
Notes: Can make some great harmonies! I added a high part for reference.

The Ken Meadows Waltz

Martin Matthews
waltz

♩ = 115

A-part

First system of the A-part. It consists of two staves. The first staff has a treble clef, a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#), and a 3/4 time signature. It begins with a repeat sign. The melody features eighth and sixteenth notes, with triplets marked '3'. Chord symbols 'A' and 'D' are placed above the staff. The second staff continues the melody with similar notation, including triplets and chord symbols 'A' and 'E'.

B-part

First system of the B-part. It consists of two staves. The first staff has a treble clef, a key signature of three sharps, and a 3/4 time signature. The melody is written in eighth and sixteenth notes, with triplets marked '3'. Chord symbols 'E' and 'A' are placed above the staff. The second staff continues the melody with similar notation, including triplets and chord symbols 'D', 'A', and 'E'.

Second system of the B-part. It consists of two staves. The first staff has a treble clef, a key signature of three sharps, and a 3/4 time signature. The melody is written in eighth and sixteenth notes, with triplets marked '3'. Chord symbols 'A' and 'D' are placed above the staff. The second staff continues the melody with similar notation, including triplets and chord symbols 'A', 'E', and 'A'. The system ends with a double bar line and the marking 'D.C.'.

A-part (low)

First system of the A-part (low). It consists of two staves. The first staff has a treble clef, a key signature of three sharps, and a 3/4 time signature. The melody is written in eighth and sixteenth notes, with triplets marked '3'. Chord symbols 'A' and 'D' are placed above the staff. The second staff continues the melody with similar notation, including triplets and chord symbols 'A' and 'E'.

Second system of the A-part (low). It consists of two staves. The first staff has a treble clef, a key signature of three sharps, and a 3/4 time signature. The melody is written in eighth and sixteenth notes, with triplets marked '3'. Chord symbols 'D' and 'A' are placed above the staff. The second staff continues the melody with similar notation, including triplets and chord symbols 'A' and 'E'. The system ends with a double bar line.